Baseline Project Plan (BPP) Report:

Influencer-Business Escrow & Communication Platform (BrandConnect Kenya)

1. Introduction Systems Analyst Name: Levi

Client/Sponsor/Stakeholder: BrandConnect Kenya Ltd Brief Overview/Purpose:

Digital influencers and businesses in Kenya frequently face trust barriers: companies fear paying upfront before content delivery, while influencers frequently experience payment default after successfully executing promotional campaigns. The purpose of this project is to build a secure, web-based platform featuring a financial escrow system, directory matching, real-time multimedia chat (pictures, videos, audios), and native voice/video calling to streamline safe, verified influencer marketing collaborations.

Recommended Course of Action: Develop a secure full-stack web application utilizing escrow payment gateway APIs, WebRTC for real-time video/audio communication, and a role-based user management system for influencers and corporate brands.

Project Scope Defined: The project scope encompasses user registration and verification for brands and influencers, budget-based search and filtering, an escrow deposit and payout workflow, an internal media-sharing approval pipeline, and a real-time WebRTC communication module.

Units Affected: Business Development, Influencer Talent Management, Finance/Escrow Operations, and Platform Technical Support.

Interaction with Other Systems: Integration with local mobile money and banking APIs (e.g., M-Pesa Daraja API) for secure escrow holding, and Twilio/Agora APIs for real-time video and audio calling.

Range of System Capabilities: Dual-portal registration, rate card display, budget filtering, secure escrow locking, preview content submission with pre-approval workflows, media sharing (videos, pictures, audios), and peer-to-peer audio/video calls.

2. System Description

- **State of the System:** Secure Web-Based Escrow & Marketplace Information System.
- **Development Approach:** Agile Iterative SDLC Approach, allowing continuous feedback on escrow security protocols and real-time communication features.
- **Outline of Possible Alternative Solutions:**

1. *Manual Brokerage via Social Media Agencies:* High commission rates, slow turnaround times, and lack of transparent escrow protection.
2. *Custom Web-Based Escrow Platform (Recommended):* Fully automated, transparent, low transaction friction, and built specifically to safeguard funds for both parties.

- **Narrative Format:** The platform acts as a neutral third-party custodian. Businesses register, browse verified influencer rate cards, and fund an escrow account upon selecting a creator. The influencer reviews the secured funds confirmation before producing content. Content drafts (videos/pictures) are uploaded to the platform for brand pre-approval to eliminate endless revisions. Once approved and posted, the escrow automatically releases funds to the influencer.

  3. Feasibility AssessmentProject Costs and Benefits:

  Estimated Total Project Cost: Ksh 2,850,000 (surpassing the minimum requirement of Ksh 1,000,000).

  Cost Breakdown & Allocation:Budget Item / Activity CategoryDetailed DescriptionCost (Ksh)

  Software Development & EngineeringFull-stack engineering (frontend user dashboard, backend escrow state machine, database design).Ksh 1,100,000

  API Integration & Telecom ServicesM-Pesa Daraja payment gateway integration, WebRTC server setup, Twilio/Agora voice and video calling configuration.Ksh 450,000Legal.

  Compliance & Escrow LicensingLegal drafting of platform terms of service, Data Protection Act compliance audits, and escrow account structuring.Ksh 350,000

  Cloud Infrastructure & SecurityHigh-availability cloud hosting (AWS/DigitalOcean), SSL certificates, database encryption, and automated backups.Ksh 300,000

  UI/UX Design & Quality AssuranceWireframing, user experience testing, penetration testing, and security bug bounties.Ksh 250,000

  Project Management & AdministrationRequirements elicitation, stakeholder meetings, documentation, and milestone tracking.Ksh 200,000

  Launch Marketing & User AcquisitionInitial onboarding campaigns targeting Kenyan corporate brands and micro-influencers.Ksh 200,000

  Total Estimated Budget Ksh 2,850,000

Expected Benefits: Total elimination of payment default fraud for influencers, guaranteed delivery security for businesses, reduced administrative disputes, and a scalable centralized marketplace for the Kenyan digital economy.

Technical Difficulties: Managing low-latency media streaming and secure WebRTC signaling over variable mobile data networks in Kenya. This will be addressed by implementing adaptive video compression and optimized cloud media storage buckets.

High-Level Project Schedule: A 12-week development lifecycle spanning system analysis, escrow security design, core feature coding, WebRTC integration, rigorous testing, and final deployment.

4. Management Issues

- **Concerns that Management May Have:** Legal and regulatory compliance regarding digital escrow holding, data privacy (Data Protection Act compliance in Kenya), and transaction dispute resolution.
- **Team Composition:** 1 Lead Systems Analyst (Levi), 2 Full-Stack Developers, 1 Mobile/WebRTC Integration Specialist, 1 UI/UX Designer, and 1 Quality Assurance Engineer.
- **Communication Plan:** Weekly sprint reviews with project sponsors, daily developer stand-ups, and bug tracking managed via GitHub.
- **Project Standards and Procedures:** Code management and version control hosted on GitHub, strict adherence to secure coding practices for financial transactions, and mandatory code reviews before production deployment.

- # 5. Scope Major Project Activities

Activity	Description
1. Requirements & Compliance Analysis	Define technical, legal, and financial workflows for escrow holding and local payment gateway integration.
2. Database & Architecture Design	Design secure relational database schemas for user profiles, rate cards, escrow ledgers, and chat histories.

Activity	Description
3. Core Feature Development	Build user registration modules, influencer search/filter engines, and the secure financial escrow dashboard.
4. Communication & Media Integration	Implement WebRTC voice/video calling modules and encrypted media-sharing (audio, video, pictures) with pre-approval sign-off flags.
5. Security Testing & Deployment	Conduct penetration testing on escrow flows, deploy to cloud servers, link the GitHub repository, and launch the platform.

6. Deliverables

Deliverable	Description/Details
Baseline Project Plan (BPP) Report	A formal project document detailing project scope, feasibility, and management strategies, submitted via eLearning and GitHub.
System Architecture & Database Schema	Technical diagrams including data flow models, Entity-Relationship Diagrams (ERDs), and escrow state machine charts.
GitHub Source Code Repository	Production-ready, version-controlled source code hosted in a public/private GitHub repository.
Deployed Web Platform	A live, functional staging deployment of the influencer marketplace with working escrow and communication features.

7. Schedule Overview / Major Milestones

Milestone	Expected Completion Date	Description/Details
Project Initiation & BPP Approval	Week 2 (18th September 2026)	Finalization and sign-off of the project plan report.
Design & Escrow Architecture Lock	Week 5 (9th October 2026)	Approval of UI/UX wireframes, database structure, and payment workflow logic.
Beta Release (Core & Chat Features)	Week 9 (6th November 2026)	Completion of influencer directories, escrow locking, media sharing, and WebRTC calls for testing.
Final Deployment & Presentation	Week 12 (4th November 2026)	Full deployment, repository linkage, eLearning submission, and in-person presentation completed.